# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, September 28, 2026

## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

## THE LIST (5 stories)

### ■ *Woman, 82, Who Once Couldn’t Lift a Cup of Tea Regains Her Strength with Exercise: ‘I Thought I’d Be Disabled for Life’*

***The Angle:*** *It's the ultimate comeback story: a woman told she'd be disabled for life rebuilt her strength from scratch at 82 — a feel-good, relatable jolt of hope for anyone who thinks it's 'too late' to get moving.*

- Subject is **82 years old**
- She once **couldn't even lift a cup of tea** due to weakness
- Quote: **"I thought I'd be disabled for life"**
- She rebuilt her strength through consistent **exercise**

**The Inspiration Check-In**

- Callers — what's the moment you decided 'I'm not too old for this'?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/woman-82-couldn-t-lift-a-cup-of-tea-now-she-exercises-4-days-a-week-at-the-gym-12134411

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### ■ *Data center developer offers $10,000 checks to 4,500 households if the 1,300-acre facility is approved - locals push back over noise and 'bribe' concerns*

***The Angle:*** *This taps into the national backlash over the AI data center boom — companies are now literally cutting checks to neighbors to make controversial mega-projects go away, and 'is that a bribe or fair compensation?' is a debate playing out in towns everywhere.*

- Developer is offering **$10,000** checks to **4,500** nearby households
- The payout is tied to approval of a massive **1,300-acre** data center facility
- Some locals are calling it a **'bribe'** dressed up as a community goodwill gesture
- Opposition is centered on fears over noise from the sprawling facility

**The Debate Starter**

- Would $10,000 be enough to get a giant data center built next to your house, or is that just a payoff?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/data-centers/data-center-developer-offers-usd10-000-checks-to-4-500-households-if-the-1-300-acre-facility-is-approved-locals-push-back-over-noise-and-bribe-concerns

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### ■ *Did Donald Trump get what he wanted in Greenland? | About That*

***The Angle:*** *After months of tariff threats and even talk of military force, Trump just signed a deal with Denmark and Greenland — but it's an updated defense pact, not the takeover he was pushing for, so the question is whether burning that much goodwill was worth it.*

- **Trump** spent months threatening **tariffs** and even floated **military action** to acquire **Greenland**
- He ultimately signed an **Arctic security pact** with the leaders of **Denmark** and **Greenland**
- The new deal updates the long-standing **1951 defence agreement** — it is **not** an outright U.S. takeover
- Experts are questioning whether the **diplomatic fallout** was worth the final result

**The Debate Starter**

- Did Trump actually win here, or did he torch a decades-old alliance for an upgrade he could've gotten by asking nicely?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7361670?cmp=rss

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### ■ *FBI offers $1M reward for tips leading to arrest of alleged gang leader tied to killing of B.C. activist*

***The Angle:*** *This isn't just a local B.C. crime story — it's a case that's already strained US-Canada-India relations, and now the FBI is putting real money on the table to crack it.*

- The **FBI** is offering **$1 million US** for tips leading to an arrest.
- The target is a top lieutenant in the **Lawrence Bishnoi gang**.
- He's accused of orchestrating the **June 2023 assassination** of Sikh activist **Hardeep Singh Nijjar**.
- The killing happened in **Surrey, B.C.**

**The Debate Starter**

- A US agency chasing a Canadian assassination tied to an alleged gang network abroad — does a $1M reward actually move the needle on a case this tangled?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/goldy-brar-bishnoi-gang-most-wanted-9.7361302?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Jayden Daniels traveling to London for return to practice in Commanders injury twist*

***The Angle:*** *The Commanders' breakout young QB has been sidelined with an elbow injury, and now he's flying across the pond and practicing again right as Washington gears up for a Week 4 showdown with the Colts — total cliffhanger for fantasy owners and Commanders fans alike.*

- **Jayden Daniels** is traveling with the **Commanders** to **London** ahead of their **Week 4** game
- He's been dealing with an **elbow injury**
- Daniels is set to **practice this week** as part of his return
- The Commanders face the **Colts** in London

**The Debate Starter**

- Do you trust a quarterback coming off an injury to go play a full game overseas, jet lag and all?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/28/sports/jayden-daniels-returning-to-practice-in-commanders-injury-twist/

Backup options:

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### ■ *Hannah-Jones' ignorant Times essay: Letters to the Editor — Sept. 29, 2026*

***The Angle:*** *The reporter behind the 1619 Project built her career on public education equity — now readers are calling out the gap between her politics and where she actually sends her own daughter.*

- **Nikole Hannah-Jones**, the **New York Times** writer known for the **1619 Project**, is accused of enrolling her daughter in a school widely labeled 'failing.'
- **New York Post** readers piled on in the paper's Letters to the Editor section, calling out what they see as political motives behind the choice.
- The backlash centers on a classic 'do as I say, not as I do' gap between public advocacy and private-school-choice reality.

**The Hypocrisy Debate**

- Would you send your own kid to a school you publicly call 'failing' just to prove a political point?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/28/opinion/hannah-jones-ignorant-times-essay-letters/

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### ■ *FBI offer US$1M reward for information leading to arrest in Nijjar killing*

***The Angle:*** *The FBI just put a million-dollar price tag on catching whoever killed Sikh activist Hardeep Singh Nijjar — a case that already blew up into a full-on diplomatic firestorm between Canada, the US, and India.*

- The **FBI** is offering a **$1 million reward** for info leading to an arrest in the killing.
- Victim: Sikh activist **Hardeep Singh Nijjar**, whose death sparked a major international incident.
- The case has already strained relations between **Canada**, the **US**, and **India** at the highest levels.

**The Debate Starter**

- A million-dollar FBI reward on a case with this much international baggage — does that number tell you how serious this got, or how stuck the investigation still is?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMisgFBVV95cUxPNVp5Q1dHT0xxQ01BWHhKLWV4N1JmcmJoamF2dGdEekZPYmFZVWJDTEZrSU9kX2QyMmduZVFwdHBlN25KNTJ3ZjdFOW1qZ19pdUNSQUFQVno4a3BoTGNlNVN4a3N6ZzFwX3VLQUlEa0QyQmgtTzZwd0ZKN2hvNThyTmZLbFQ2dnRUWUdNR3dyTXFOaDVoRS15WjJST1ltS2dpSjJ5ZElQSnFXV202Sk56cVFR?oc=5

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## CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

### ■ *Trump administration muses about hitting Canada with EU-style tariffs over Carney's EU pivot*

***The Angle:*** *A fresh round of US-Canada trade tension is brewing, reportedly sparked by Carney cozying up to the EU - and tariffs always hit home fast for Canadian wallets and jobs, so this is one Canadians will want to watch closely.*

- **Trump administration** is reportedly considering **EU-style tariffs** on Canada
- The move appears linked to PM **Mark Carney**'s recent pivot toward closer **EU** ties
- Signals another possible flare-up in **US-Canada trade relations**

**The Debate Starter**

- If Washington slaps EU-style tariffs on us over a European trade pivot, who should Canada actually be cozying up to - the US or the EU?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nationalpost.com/news/trump-administration-muses-about-hitting-canada-with-eu-style-tariffs-over-carneys-eu-pivot

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### ■ *Alberta Separatists unveil development slogan "Come Invest in our unstable breakaway republic!"*

***The Angle:*** *Alberta's separatist chatter has been simmering for a while, but this joke slogan making the rounds on r/canada — basically admitting the whole 'breakaway republic' idea is a hard sell — is the kind of self-own that writes its own punchline for hosts.*

- The mock slogan making the rounds: **"Come invest in our unstable breakaway republic!"**
- It's spreading out of **r/canada**, aimed squarely at the Alberta sovereignty/separatist movement
- The joke lands because it says the quiet part out loud - investor confidence and 'stable breakaway republic' don't usually go together

**The Debate Starter**

- Would YOU invest a dollar in an independent Alberta - be honest?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Read the slogan cold** - Kick things off -> Hosts read the slogan deadpan like an actual tourism ad voiceover before revealing it's satire
- **Step 2: Worse-slogan game** - 60 seconds, back and forth -> Each host has to invent an even worse tagline for an independent Alberta (or any breakaway province) live on air
- **Step 3: Phone-in gut check** - Open the lines -> Ask listeners: would you actually put money into a separatist Alberta, and why or why not

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/09/alberta-separatists-unveil-development-slogan-come-invest-in-our-unstable-breakaway-republic/

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### ■ *B.C. politicians, leaders condemn white nationalist gathering on First Nation reserve*

***The Angle:*** *A white nationalist gathering held on First Nation land in B.C. is drawing swift, unified condemnation from politicians — a flashpoint story about hate groups targeting Indigenous communities that's guaranteed to spark strong reaction.*

- A **white nationalist gathering** reportedly took place on a **First Nation reserve** in **B.C.**
- **B.C. politicians and community leaders** have publicly condemned the event
- Details on the specific group, location, and turnout are still limited in early reporting

**The Debate Starter**

- Should authorities be doing more to stop hate groups from targeting Indigenous communities like this?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/bc-candidates-against-white-nationalist-gathering-9.7360498?cmp=rss

Backup options:

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### ■ *This Ontario city had its 'worst' problems with homecoming parties, even filling a hospital ER*

***The Angle:*** *A university party weekend turned into an actual public-health strain in Guelph, with the mayor calling it one of the worst years yet — it's a snapshot of a bigger back-to-school problem playing out across Ontario campus towns.*

- **Guelph Mayor Cam Guthrie** called this year's off-campus homecoming parties among the **worst** the city has seen
- The parties strained community resources enough to **fill a hospital ER**
- Guthrie says the impact was felt **community-wide**, not just around campus
- Other **Ontario cities** have dealt with similar grief over unsanctioned student parties

**The Debate Starter**

- Is this just kids being kids, or is it time for university towns to crack down hard on off-campus parties?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/kitchener-waterloo/guelph-homecoming-parties-police-mayor-9.7360771?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Stelco to lay off 350 steelworkers at Hamilton plant, union says*

***The Angle:*** *Stelco cutting 350 jobs at its Hamilton plant is a gut-punch to a city whose identity is built on steel - the kind of story that ripples through families and local economies far beyond one factory floor.*

- **Stelco** is laying off **350 steelworkers** at its **Hamilton** plant
- The union is the one confirming the cuts publicly

**The Reality Check**

- 350 families in Hamilton just got hit - what happens to a steel town when the mill starts shrinking?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiugFBVV95cUxNcUkzV3JqTXZmMGRtRGVRaW9qSnNrb3FRSlo5UWFwb3h0c3oyQW1VeXh3OU5IRnVxT1hhcWY4elROUy02cUttTEp5NnRsNzBZTHkyVEFaMEZHTGtscUFoOVNPTVRiaU1GYXBiMTFkYnBBRkY5d2hOOTZBX2I3UklHaWRTMjVXVHdIekhqXzl3dVBZVzVteTdYX2ZlZHVBTWpxbU1xWDN4VHc4aW1oY0lpZWRtaTVvT1FaMFE?oc=5

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### ■ *RCMP investigating apparent white nationalist demonstration on Indigenous land near Kamloops*

***The Angle:*** *The RCMP is now investigating after what's being described as a white nationalist demonstration on Indigenous land near Kamloops — a city already carrying enormous weight in Canada's reconciliation conversation since the 2021 unmarked graves discovery there.*

- **RCMP** confirms it is investigating the incident
- Demonstration reportedly took place on **Indigenous land** near **Kamloops, B.C.**
- Described as an **apparent white nationalist** gathering — details still emerging

**The Gut Check**

- Why does this keep happening in the same places tied to Canada's reconciliation reckoning — and what should actually happen to the people involved?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMizwFBVV95cUxQU3pZRzZNd0V6UmJmYmFnTTVsOWZ3TGpaREgwdV9qNlZ1V0VIenlWRGp2YTBHb1BMM2ZIQTc4akRrLTNkSkgtUjRaRG1CX1g4eXc2Z2hKT3NGb3RlU1Y3OGtVcDYwdFdZLXFScmxBY0hXZ2tmMmpRN1ZyT09SNEd1ZHNDeE9CUmhSdzFJbGJSekhjLWx1b2dLZ1FQOTh1SGkxSzhFLTB5OGlxTmFfLV9hR0NBRWVPRHNUQmFIM0FJc3d0Rms4OEpidG9CcnNFVkk?oc=5

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## ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

### ■ *Barbara Palvin gives birth, welcomes first baby with Dylan Sprouse*

***The Angle:*** *A Victoria's Secret Angel and a former Disney Channel heartthrob just welcomed their first kid together - it's the kind of only-in-Hollywood pairing that gets fans invested, and baby news always brings the good vibes to entertainment segments.*

- **Barbara Palvin** and **Dylan Sprouse** have welcomed their first baby together.
- The couple's newborn arrived over **Labor Day weekend**.
- **Palvin** is a **Victoria's Secret Angel**; **Sprouse** rose to fame as a **Disney Channel** star.

**The Sweet Moment**

- Which unexpected celeb pairing do you still think about the most?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/28/parents/barbara-palvin-gives-birth-welcomes-first-baby-with-dylan-sprouse/

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### ■ *Anne Hathaway Blocked from ‘Hot Ones’ on ‘Verity’ Press Tour After Doctor Warns It Could Disrupt Pregnancy: ‘I Might Go Into Early Labor’*

***The Angle:*** *A very pregnant Anne Hathaway reportedly got doctor's orders to skip the spicy wing gauntlet on her 'Verity' press tour, worried the hot sauce could trigger early labor - a wild, relatable collision of celebrity press duty and pregnancy reality.*

- Doctor allegedly warned Hathaway the spicy wings **"could disrupt pregnancy"**
- Hathaway reportedly said **"I might go into early labor"**
- She was pulled from a planned **'Hot Ones'** appearance on the **'Verity'** press tour

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you risk the ghost pepper wings while pregnant, or is skipping Hot Ones the only smart move here?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/anne-hathaway-banned-hot-ones-verity-press-tour-pregnancy-1236877379/

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### ■■ *Hayden Panettiere’s Ex-Fiancé Wladimir Klitschko Files for Temporary Guardianship of Her Estate on Behalf of Their Daughter Kaya*

***The Angle:*** *Hayden Panettiere's rocky personal history has been tabloid fodder for years, and now her ex Wladimir Klitschko making a legal move to protect their daughter's interests is the kind of real-life family drama that gets people talking.*

- **Wladimir Klitschko**, Hayden Panettiere's ex-fiancé, has filed for **temporary guardianship** of her estate
- The filing is made on behalf of their daughter, **Kaya**
- Klitschko and Panettiere share custody history dating back to their years-long relationship

**The Debate Starter**

- Is this a co-parent stepping up to protect their kid, or a sign something bigger is going on with Hayden?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/hayden-panettiere-ex-wladimir-klitschko-files-guardianship-petition-daughter-kaya-12146315

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### ■ *Moment California surfer smashed onto rocks by hurricane-powered wave before celebrity publicist's daring rescue*

***The Angle:*** *It's a real-life action movie moment caught on video - a hurricane swell drives a surfer straight into the rocks, and the person who saves him isn't a lifeguard, it's a celebrity publicist. That twist is exactly the kind of jaw-dropping clip that blows up online.*

- A **hurricane-powered wave** slammed a California surfer directly into the rocks.
- **Benita Karo**, a celebrity publicist, immediately sprinted toward the water to help.
- She watched anxiously to see whether the surfer would **resurface** after the impact.

**The Watercooler Moment**

- Would you have run toward the water or called for help - and does anyone actually know what to do in that split second?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/28/us-news/celebrity-publicist-rescues-unconscious-la-surfer-from-rough-surf/

Backup options:

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### ■ *'Digger' LA premiere red carpet: Tom Cruise, Jessica Alba, Kirsten Dunst and more*

***The Angle:*** *A stacked celebrity turnout always gets people clicking through the photos, and this one's got A-list staying power plus a surprise pairing that'll get people talking about who wore what.*

- **Tom Cruise** walked the red carpet at the LA premiere of **'Digger'**
- **Jessica Alba** and **Kirsten Dunst** were also among the stars in attendance
- Red carpet fashion was the focus, with outlets rounding up all the looks from the night

**The Style Debate**

- Who do you think won the red carpet that night - text us your pick.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/28/photos/digger-la-premiere-red-carpet-tom-cruise-jessica-alba-kirsten-dunst-and-more/

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### ■ *Todd Rundgren Slams Taylor Swift, Says She 'Ruined Music' and Is 'the Apotheosis of Mediocrity'*

***The Angle:*** *A 70s rock icon just torched the biggest pop star on the planet — that's an instant generational grudge match, and Swifties are already loading up the replies.*

- **Todd Rundgren** — the singer-songwriter/producer behind **"Hello It's Me"** and **"I Saw the Light"** — went off on **Taylor Swift** in a new interview.
- His exact line: **"Taylor Swift is the apotheosis of mediocrity."**
- He also claims she **"ruined music."**
- The comments came in an interview with **Vulture**.

**The Debate Starter**

- Cranky old rocker out of touch, or does he actually have a point about pop's biggest star?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Read The Quote Cold** - Kick things off -> One host reads Rundgren's 'apotheosis of mediocrity' line dead serious, no context, and gauges the other host's gut reaction.
- **Step 2: Pick A Side** - 60-second debate -> Hosts split up — one defends Swift's catalog, one channels Rundgren's rock-purist gripe — and argue it out fast.
- **Step 3: Phone Lines Open** - Listener callout -> Ask listeners to call/text: which artist from their generation gets unfairly torched by the older guard?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/music/news/todd-rundgren-slams-taylor-swift-1236877824/

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### ■ *MTV Video Music Awards: Taylor Swift Wins Video of the Year - The Hollywood Reporter*

***The Angle:*** *The VMAs handed their top prize, Video of the Year, to Taylor Swift, while Madonna walked away with three trophies of her own - it's a guaranteed pop-culture water-cooler moment with two of music's biggest names sharing the spotlight.*

- **Taylor Swift** won **Video of the Year** at the 2026 MTV VMAs.
- **Madonna** took home **three awards** during the broadcast.
- **Snoop Dogg** hosted this year's ceremony.
- Swift also received the brand-new **MTV VMA Artist Director Honors**, presented to her by **Dakota Johnson**.

**The Debate Starter**

- Biggest night: is this Taylor's VMAs or Madonna's - who actually 'won' the show?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/lists/mtv-vmas-2026-winners-list/

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### ■ *'Avengers: Doomsday' Director Explains It's 'Difficult' to Evolve MCU Characters - Variety*

***The Angle:*** *Marvel's biggest crossover in years is coming, and the director just admitted the tightrope act of changing characters fans have loved for over a decade without breaking them.*

- Co-director **Anthony Russo** is opening up about the pressure of evolving the MCU's most iconic heroes
- He says finding the balance in **moving characters forward** is genuinely **"difficult"**
- Comes as anticipation builds for **'Avengers: Doomsday'**, one of the studio's most-watched upcoming releases

**The Debate Starter**

- Which superhero do you NOT want them to mess with - call in and defend your favorite.

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/avengers-doomsday-director-very-difficult-mcu-characters-1236876967/

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## TRENDING TODAY

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### ■ *The Internet Marked Flock Safety CEO’s Home As A Public Toilet Online*

***The Angle:*** *Flock Safety's facial-recognition and license-plate cameras have made it one of the most controversial surveillance companies in the country, and now internet backlash is getting personal — someone found the CEO's home address and flooded map apps with fake public-restroom listings. It's the kind of petty, creative internet revenge that always gets people talking.*

- **Flock Safety** — the surveillance-camera company behind license-plate readers used by police nationwide — is the target here
- Online users reportedly tagged the **CEO's home address** as a **public restroom** on map/navigation apps
- The move looks like backlash tied to ongoing privacy concerns over Flock's surveillance tech

**The Debate Starter**

- Is doxxing-style 'map trolling' fair pushback on surveillance tech, or has the internet crossed a line into harassment?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gadgetreview.com/the-internet-marked-flock-safety-ceos-home-as-a-public-toilet-online

Backup options:

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### ■ *TikTok, X reportedly barring ads for documentary about Elon Musk*

***The Angle:*** *A documentary about Elon Musk is reportedly getting shut out of ad space on the two platforms most tied to him — TikTok and his own X — while YouTube and Meta let it run. That's a juicy little irony that practically begs for a debate about bias, control, and who gets to decide what ads you see.*

- Ads for a **documentary about Elon Musk** were reportedly **banned on both TikTok and X**
- The ads faced **brief delays** before being approved elsewhere
- The same ads are **now running on YouTube and Meta's platforms**
- **X** is, notably, **owned by Musk himself** — the subject of the film

**The Debate Starter**

- Is it a coincidence Musk's own platform won't run ads for a documentary about him — or exactly what you'd expect?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/musk-documentary-ads-blocked-youtube-meta-tiktok-9.7361211?cmp=rss

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### ■ *Tom Brady Gave Ex Gisele Bündchen a 'Middle Finger' Through Social Media After Divorce, New Book Says - People.com*

***The Angle:*** *Tom Brady and Gisele Bündchen are two of the most-watched exes in the world, and a new tell-all claiming he threw shade at her online post-divorce is exactly the kind of celebrity petty-drama moment that gets everyone talking.*

- A new book claims **Tom Brady** gave ex-wife **Gisele Bündchen** a symbolic **"middle finger"** through social media.
- The gesture reportedly came **after their divorce**.
- Details are surfacing via **People.com**, tied to the book's release.

**The Debate Starter**

- What's the most petty thing you've seen an ex do online after a breakup?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMixgFBVV95cUxOelZ5NXJUTktsQUdaX0tFMDRXS2lXeWNGckZuNS1sWFlTWGlzdjNTeHRBZnVLRWw2djI0RGl0NTlHNXdNNl9xY1lqQlB0M0RFYlBWS0xuRzZIRTEtT2l3TEVkeTdBM3V5T1oxaXE5Zm1VUlltVl90SHFYb1lYU0drTGtzNVA3a3p0WUdwV3M1Yjg4b3pKb183RkdxSVRtaXpBQXEtMllkVXNkVmw3S3k3dTJCOXBvbFBCSVRnNHRjSkhBZ2w3RVE?oc=5

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## LIFESTYLE CHAT

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### ■ *A camera system at a Wyoming wind farm is helping protect eagles by automatically slowing turbines when birds approach. A study estimated the system reduced eagle fatalities by 82% at the 110 turbine site, showing how technology can make wind power safer for wildlife.*

***The Angle:*** *It's the classic 'can we have clean energy without killing wildlife' debate, but with an actual win — smart cameras are slashing eagle deaths at a Wyoming wind farm, and the numbers are wild.*

- A camera system at a **Wyoming wind farm** automatically slows down turbines when eagles get close
- A study found it cut eagle deaths by **82%** at the site
- The site has **110 turbines** total
- It's being framed as proof tech can make wind power coexist with wildlife

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you have guessed a camera system could cut eagle deaths by over 80% — and should every wind farm be required to install one?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/wyoming-wind-farm-ai-cameras-eagles/37136/

Backup options:

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### ■ *Tinder Swindler Claims His Scamming Past Makes Him the Perfect Person To Build a 'Safe' Dating App*

***The Angle:*** *This is peak 'you can't make this up' energy — a guy famous for scamming women out of millions is now pitching himself as the dating world's safety expert, which is exactly the kind of absurd, internet-baiting headline that gets two hosts talking.*

- The self-proclaimed **'Tinder Swindler'** claims his history of scamming women is actually a qualification for building a **safer dating app**.
- His logic, apparently: **who better to catch a con than the guy who used to run one?**

**The Debate Starter**

- Would you ever trust a 'safe dating app' built by the guy who scammed people on the last one?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/tinder-swindler-simon-leviev-safe-love-app-blocked-1764581

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### ■ *Tylenol during pregnancy not linked to autism, ADHD, major review finds*

***The Angle:*** *This is one of the most googled pregnancy health scares out there, and a major review just pushed back hard against the panic — perfect for parents (and worried grandparents) listening right now.*

- A **major scientific review** found **no link** between taking **Tylenol (acetaminophen)** during pregnancy and a child later being diagnosed with **autism or ADHD**.
- The review directly challenges years of public worry and warnings that tied the common over-the-counter pain reliever to developmental disorders.

**The Phone-In Trigger**

- If you took Tylenol while pregnant and spiraled about it afterward — call in, because science just told you to relax.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cidrap.umn.edu/anti-science/tylenol-during-pregnancy-not-linked-autism-adhd-major-review-finds

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## CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

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### ■ *Which way, ladies?*

***The Angle:*** *It's a viral 'which fork in the road' meme template, but the punchline about running low on eggs turns it into a sneaky joke about grocery prices and life priorities - the kind of post that gets forwarded with a laughing-crying emoji.*

- Posted by **@WomenBeingAwful**, a meme/humor account
- The joke plays on the classic "which way" decision-meme format
- Punchline: priorities apparently shift **"the less and less eggs"** you have left

**The Caption Contest**

- Read the tweet cold on air and have each host guess the punchline before you reveal it.

X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/WomenBeingAwful/status/2104695559684522425

Backup options:

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### ■ *Driver accused of driving SUV into a Kroger because he needed to use the bathroom*

***The Angle:*** *It's the perfect so-dumb-it's-real headline for the end of the show — a bathroom emergency escalating into property damage is exactly the kind of story that gets people laughing and sharing before their coffee break.*

- A driver allegedly **drove an SUV straight into a Kroger** grocery store
- His reported excuse: he **desperately needed to use the bathroom**

**The Phone-In Trigger**

- Call in: what's the craziest thing you've ever done because you REALLY had to go?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.click2houston.com/news/local/2026/09/28/driver-accused-of-ramming-through-rosenberg-grocery-store-upset-because-he-needed-to-use-the-bathroom/

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## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

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## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

### ■■ *Thieves steal Nvidia-branded trailers expecting valuable hardware, find 40,000 pounds of sand instead.*

***The Angle:*** *With Nvidia the hottest name in tech thanks to the AI chip boom, thieves bet big on a high-value heist - and got played by branding instead of hardware. It's the ultimate anticlimax story, tailor-made for a laugh on air.*

- **Thieves** targeted trailers stamped with the **Nvidia** logo, clearly betting on a load of valuable tech.
- Instead of chips or GPUs, they made off with **40,000 pounds of sand**.
- The branding was apparently the only "valuable" part of the trailers.

**The Plot Twist**

- What's the most epic fail you've seen when someone went all-in expecting a jackpot and got nothing?

**ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Set Up the Letdown** - 30 seconds, cold open -> Host reads the headline straight, building up the image of a slick Nvidia heist before dropping the sand punchline.
- **Step 2: Phone Lines: Biggest Anticlimax** - 2-3 minutes, caller bit -> Ask listeners to call/text their own "expected gold, got sand" moment - bad Craigslist buys, mislabeled boxes, hyped-up dates that fizzled.
- **Step 3: Co-Host Reaction Round** - 1 minute, banter -> Have the other host guess what they'd have assumed was in an Nvidia-branded trailer before the reveal.

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114008-thieves-steal-nvidia-branded-trailers-expecting-valuable-hardware.html

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## BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

### ■■■ *Crows are being given naloxone after suspected drug overdoses in Prince George*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Absurdist-but-true 'crows on naloxone' has the exact so-strange-it-must-be-shared quality that turns r/nottheonion posts into cross-platform meme fodder.
***The Angle:*** *A Prince George neighborhood claims crows are keeling over from suspected drug exposure and residents are stepping in with naloxone - it's the kind of wonderfully weird local headline that spreads nationwide because nobody can quite believe it's real.*

- Reports out of **Prince George, B.C.** describe crows suspected of overdosing on drugs in the area
- Locals have reportedly used **naloxone** (Narcan) to revive the birds
- Story is making the rounds via **r/nottheonion**, the internet's home for real news that reads like satire

**The 'Wait, What?' Moment**

- Somewhere in Prince George there's a person who now carries Narcan for birds - and honestly, respect.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/crows-overdose-prince-george-naloxone-9.7358727

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### ■ *$745K returned to donors after GoFundMe says elderly couple's daughter made up neighbor's identity*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A daughter faking a neighbor's identity to scam GoFundMe donors is a jaw-dropping betrayal twist that outrage-driven true-crime audiences reliably amplify.
***The Angle:*** *It's got everything a kicker needs — a heartwarming charity campaign, a wild twist, and a six-figure gut-punch, all wrapped up in a real-life 'wait, WHAT' headline that practically writes its own segment.*

- **GoFundMe** says it refunded **$745,000** to donors after uncovering the fraud.
- The campaign was raised on behalf of an **elderly couple**.
- Investigators say the couple's own **daughter** allegedly invented a fake **neighbor's identity** to run it.

**The Jaw-Drop**

- Your own kid fakes a total stranger's identity to raise money 'for you' online — is that a twisted act of love or just straight-up fraud?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://fox4news.com/news/745k-returned-donors-after-gofundme-says-elderly-couples-daughter-made-up-neighbors-identity

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### ■ *Book Award Winner Complains About White Paint Because of Its “Purity” and “Cleanliness”*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An author complaining that white paint is 'pure' is tailor-made culture-war bait that screenshots and ragebait accounts thrive on, even starting from zero.
***The Angle:*** *A total 'wait, what?' headline straight out of r/nottheonion — a celebrated author is apparently calling out white paint shades for leaning on words like 'purity' and 'cleanliness,' and that's exactly the kind of oddball culture-war-meets-home-decor story that makes for a great kicker.*

**The Eye-Roll Starter**

- Ask listeners: is this a fair point about loaded language, or are we officially out of things to be offended by?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thenewamerican.com/us/culture/book-award-winner-complains-about-white-paint-because-of-its-purity-and-cleanliness/

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### ■■ *The Mighty Sparrow, Trinidadian Titan of Calypso, Is Dead at 91*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The Mighty Sparrow was a genuine legend of Caribbean music, and legacy-artist obituaries often see a delayed surge as tribute posts and old performance clips recirculate.
***The Angle:*** *The man widely crowned the 'Calypso King of the World' has passed away, closing out a career that helped carry Trinidadian music onto the global stage — a genuine moment for an on-air tribute and a chance to spotlight a genre listeners may not know much about.*

- **The Mighty Sparrow**, the legendary Trinidadian calypso singer, has died at age **91**
- Widely regarded as one of the towering figures — a 'titan' — of **calypso music**

**The Tribute Beat**

- Callers: what's the first calypso or steelpan song that ever hooked you?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/09/27/arts/music/the-mighty-sparrow-dead.html

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### ■ *Matthew Stafford, wife Kelly make surprise cameo in Taylor Swift's 'Patient Zero' video https://t.co/l5NSe0UfXf https://t.co/ABIeiI6b8B*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Any Taylor Swift music-video cameo carries her fanbase's outsized engagement multiplier regardless of who else is in it.
***The Angle:*** *Taylor Swift dropping surprise celebrity cameos always sends the internet into detective mode, and this time it's an NFL quarterback and his wife popping up in the 'Patient Zero' video - pure pop culture crossover bait.*

- **Matthew Stafford** and wife **Kelly Stafford** show up in a surprise cameo
- The cameo is in **Taylor Swift's** music video for **'Patient Zero'**
- Pairing an NFL star with Swift's rollout taps both sports and pop fanbases at once

**The Crossover Reaction**

- Which other athlete would you love to see randomly pop up in a Taylor Swift video?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2104746017392390236

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### ■ *Trans NYT exec threatened to kill wife, scared their kids with chilling book before his in-laws shot him dead: docs https://t.co/JXriJtqyaw*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A closeted murder-threat plot ending in a in-law shooting has the shock-twist true-crime structure that tends to outperform its initial numbers once details spread.
***The Angle:*** *A senior New York Times executive is dead after allegedly threatening to kill his wife and terrifying his own kids — and it was his in-laws who pulled the trigger. It's the kind of jaw-dropping true-crime-meets-media-world story that makes for can't-look-away chat.*

- The executive was **transgender** and worked at **The New York Times**
- Court docs allege he **threatened to kill his wife**
- He reportedly used a **"chilling" book** to scare their kids
- He was ultimately **shot dead by his in-laws**, according to the documents

**The Debate Starter**

- When does protecting your family cross the line from self-defense into vigilante justice?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 52/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2104770347417346246

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## FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 6 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)

- "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre ‘hands across the sand’ protest against California oil drilling" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-28)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 20 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)
- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in ‘Damn Yankees’ Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill" (Playbill.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-09-28)

Newly banked this run:

- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre ‘hands across the sand’ protest against California oil drilling"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill"

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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-28 11:44 PM